

Meander

A meander is a curve or bend in a river. It forms when the flow of water wears away the land on one side of the river, then dumps the broken-down rocks this creates on the other side, increasing the area of land there.

Fertile floodplains

These are flat areas of land next to a river. Water in a river may increase for some reason and become too much for the river to carry. It then overflows onto the floodplain. Soil in floodplains is usually very fertile.

Estuary or delta

Near the sea, salt water mixes with fresh water, forming an estuary. The land is flatter, so the river slows down. If it slows down enough, mud is deposited, creating a delta with several channels that the river now flows through.

Mouth

The river's journey ends here. It is where it finally flows into the sea, ocean, or other large body of water, such as a lake.

Li River, China, Asia

Katmai Peninsula, Alaska, USA, North America

Slow-Flowing

MIDDLE COURSE

LOWER COURSE